

**"We almost have 12 projects in our hands with an investment of more than Rs 5,000 crore, most of which are coming through public-private partnerships"**

**RATHENDRA RAMAN**
Chairman,
Kolkata Port Trust

The first one is port modernisation. Under SagarMala, we have 830 projects, of which nearly 230 are only for modernisation, where we are trying to revamp, create new infrastructure, add new cranes, bring in PPP investments and establish industries near ports.

The second vertical is industrialisation, where we are encouraging EXIM (export-import)-oriented industries to set up their facilities in port areas so that they need not spend money in transportation.

The third one is connectivity. Ports need world-class road and rail links. Around 298 projects worth Rs 2 lakh crore are in the works to enhance connectivity. Nearly 80 of these have already been completed.

The fourth one is coastal shipping and inland waterways. India has 111 waterways, and the government wants to promote more trade movement through these. The cargo volume in the last 10 years has jumped from 8 million to 130 million. In coastal shipping also, there is a huge jump—from 20-30 million tonnes to around 150 million tonnes. We are creating a dedicated bus for coastal shipping.

The fifth vertical is skill development. We are providing 100 per cent funding support to skill people and are also taking fishermen onboard, training them, modernising their fishing harbour, and creating new ones.

### WHAT SETS THE KOLKATA PORT APART

**Raman:** The 153-year-old Kolkata Port, officially known as the Syama Prasad Mookerjee Port, is a unique one with a two-dock system—Kolkata Dock System and the Haldia Dock Complex. It is a riverine port with a draft challenge—major vessels cannot come inside. But it has its own advantages. The port is well connected to most of eastern and northeastern states. We have initiated a number of steps for modernisation.

In the last seven years, we have increased capacity from 71 million tonnes to 87 million tonnes. In the next seven years, we hope to enhance it by 30 million tonnes. We also see a lot of opportunities for river cruise as we have locations such as the Sundarbans, Mayapur, and Raychak near Kolkata. ■

**"Right now, infrastructure projects tend to become NPAs very fast...Infrastructure development has been a challenge for India for many years"**

**DR CHARAN SINGH**
Non-Executive Chairman,
Punjab & Sind Bank



**Charan Singh**, non-executive chairman of the Punjab & Sind Bank, **Amit Kapoor**, joint managing partner at Jyoti Sagar Associates, and **Harry Dhaul**, director-general of Independent Power Producers Association of India, talk of the challenges in infrastructure financing in India and ways to overcome them.

### THE FUTURE OF IPPs

**Dhaul:** The situation with independent power projects (IPPs) now is a bit different. This government has turned it around 180 degrees; now, international investors are coming to India because it is a country worth investing in. However, the question is that India does not have long-term finance. We do not have a debt market. So, you can't take a debt instrument, how you trade equity, you are not able